rose up in his name'. Indeed, '[i]t remained a terrible cautionary tale for him ever after'. And yet, '[f]ew shared this stand' because although 'Jawaharlal Nehru, Sardar Patel and Rajendra Prasad reluctantly went along, others like Chittaranjan Das and Motilal Nehru dissented' because 'they felt let down'. Perhaps, the magnitude of the betrayal felt was expressed most poetically by Lala Lajpat Rai in his lament, 'Our defeat is in proportion to the greatness of our leader.'[2] Subhas Chandra Bose caustically observed how '[n]o one could understand why Mahatma should have used the isolated incident at Chauri Chaura for strangling the movement all over the country.'[3] In the words of Tim Murphy 'for the moderates, Chauri Chaura showed how quickly open defiance of the Raj could collapse, and they were antagonised by Gandhi's failure to negotiate with its offers of reform.'[4] Yet the shame of the Chauri Chaura incident lies forgotten in India today, even in relation to Gandhi himself.

Gandhi's rescission of his campaign had another effect. It created a political vacuum. Many in the non-violent resistance were so stunned and left so deeply aggrieved that they abandoned the non-violent struggle altogether. New radical revolutionary movements moved in to fill the vacuum. These aimed to overthrow British rule by violent means. A paradox arose—the very leaders who were participants in the non-cooperation movement felt failed by it. They moved on to become leaders of a new revolutionary 'terror' politics, when previously they had been ardent participants in Gandhi's non-cooperation movement. This not only demonstrates the extent of their disenchantment with non-violent resistance but also emphasizes the importance of their kind of politics in India's freedom movement after the 1920s. Gandhian non-violence is accredited with the march towards India's freedom when this is just half the story. The other half remains unpalatable and unspoken of even today. It is that it was not just Sukhdev, Shiv Verma, Bhagwati Charan Vohra and Jaidev Kapoor, who had previously been passionate adherents of Gandhi's peaceful non-cooperation movement, who now rejected it. It was also others like Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee, Surya Sen, Jatin Das and Chandrashekhar Azad. All left the Congress Party.